

Sol-fa

Level 1





About the Course

March, imitate, and play games with music. Explore how simple melodic patterns and rhythms build into scales. Finish with an understanding of dynamics, basic rhythms, and the sol-fa scale. Audio lessons are provided with the lesson plans.

Skill Focus: Rhythm, melody, scales, dynamics, and sol-fa syllables ("do" - "so").

This topic is included in the following course(s): Music: Level 1



Placement & Combining Tips

Grade 3 students with no experience with sol-fa or sight-reading music may start with Level 1.



Scheduling

GRADE	SCHEDULE INFO.	BOOKS
2+	Sol-fa: Level 1 1 time/week 10 min	Sol-fa Level 1 Audio Lessons

Sample Weekly View

Day 1	Day 2	Day 3	Day 4	Day 5
Music: Level 1				
Sol-fa: Level 1	Hymns & Spirituals Afternoon Listening		Folk Songs	Composer Study



Planning & Prep

Permission to print for non-commercial use. See Alveary group use policy to use lessons in a group context.

LINKS: Click text or scan the QR code in the top corner of the lesson plan pages to view online resources associated with the lessons.

Responsibility for previewing all links rests with the teacher. All links were checked at the time of publication; however, websites change frequently and may contain objectionable content. Please report broken links by contacting us through our website.

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☐ Bookmark Sol-fa playlists (see Quick Links). If you create a free account on the SoundCloud app, the Sol-Fa lessons become downloadable for offline use.



Books & Resources

For book rationales and purchase options, click the Book List link or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Book List Details](#)

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Our Work: Grades 1-2



Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs PDF



Sol-fa Level 1 Audio Lessons



Supplies

For supply list details and basic supplies helpful to have on hand, click the links or scan the QR code below.

∞ [View Basic Supplies](#)

(No Subject Supplies Assigned)



Quick Links

Sol-fa: Level 1

∞ [Extra Helpings](#)

∞ [Sol-fa SoundCloud Playlist](#)

∞ [Warm-Ups](#)

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code for links.



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How To Teach



Recap

- Specific recap questions are often suggested in the day's plans; ask students what they remember from the last lesson. If nothing comes to mind at first, tell them to give themselves another minute or two and to keep thinking. Our brains are amazing and can usually recall the previous lesson with a minute of effort. Refrain from doing the work of remembering yourself if you are leading the lessons.
- For composer study, a recap might look like a brief discussion about the name or sound of the piece you listened to previously.
- For hymns and folk songs, this might be an effort to hum the melody or recite the words of the song you're currently learning.
- For sol-fa, it might be a quick explanation of the sol-fa syllable you learned or a tricky rhythm or interval you were working to master.
- If students have difficulty recalling, teachers might try showing them a picture or sharing something that the teacher remembers. This will often refresh their memory enough to allow them to recall.
- If students still cannot recall anything from the last reading, then teachers may consider continuing anyway or repeating the last lesson.



Introduce

- Prepare to listen to the day's musical selection by inviting students to consider an interesting musical or historical idea in the lesson. Perhaps it's a unique word, rhythm, instrument, or piece of historical background. You might introduce it by the way, or read a selection of a composer's bio or a brief article to students.



Listen & Sing

- Listen to the day's musical selection.
- Composer study lessons will usually have you listen to a piece of music for 3-8 minutes. If students have a difficult time listening for the duration of the lesson, stop the music at their limit.
- Some students might draw, color, or engage in a handicraft while listening to help extend their listening time. Students who have a difficult time sitting still or listening may benefit from: a fidget of their choice, such as a piece of putty or clay or an afghan; flexible positioning, such as a wobble seat or inverted sitting; or sensory modulation, such as a weighted vest or blanket or adjustment of light, temperature, or sound.
- Hymn, folk song, or sol-fa lessons will sometimes have you listen to a part of the song and then practice echoing back the melody and/or words.



Discuss

- Composer Study: Talk about the musical selection you heard. What stood out to you? What did you notice? What did it make you wonder? Did it remind you of anything? Discuss the tempo, the sound of the music, the instruments used, the volume, and the mood. Why do you think the composer wrote it the way he did?
- Hymns, Spirituals, & Folk Songs: What lines strike you particularly? Is there a rhyme scheme to the lyrics? Is there a progression to each stanza? If you were to add a verse to the song, what would you add? If you took a verse out, how do you think it would change the song? Do the

melody and words go together? Why or why not?

- Sol-fa: Take a minute to reflect on what you learned in the lesson. Write down any notes you want to remember and practice any particular exercises that were tricky.



Connect

- At the end of the lesson, think about how the day's musical selection connects to other books, subjects, characters in history, etc.
- You might copy down a stanza of a hymn in your Commonplace or Copywork book, read a bit more about the history behind a piece of music, jot down a noteworthy date in your Book of Centuries, or discuss a broader question raised in the lesson.



Term 1

WEEK 1 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 1
Humming, Lip Trills, Steady Beats

→ INTRO
We're going to start learning how to sight-sing this term. Eventually, we'll be reading music, but first, we need to train our ears! As you work on singing melodies and rhythms, notice how your sol-fa lessons can help you sing your hymns or folk songs.

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 1

WEEK 2 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 2
Rhythms

→ RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 2

WEEK 3 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 3
Rhythms (cont.)

→ RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 3

WEEK 4 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 4
Rhythms (cont.)

→ RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 4

WEEK 5 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 5
Pitch

→ RECAP
Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson.
∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups

→ LISTEN & PRACTICE
Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed.
∞ Audio Link: Lesson 5

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Term 1	
WEEK 6 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 6 High and Low Pitches → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 6	
WEEK 7 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 7 Rhythmic Patterns → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 7	
WEEK 8 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 8 Melodic Patterns → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 8	
WEEK 9 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 9 Melodic and Rhythmic Patterns (cont.) → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 9	
WEEK 10 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 10 Melodic and Rhythmic Patterns (cont.) → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 10	
WEEK 11 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 11 Melodic and Rhythmic Patterns (cont.) → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups	

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Term 1	
→ LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 11	
WEEK 12  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 12 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Sol-fa Level 1 Coursework	

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Term 2

WEEK 1 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 13 Melodies with the Piano → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 12	
WEEK 2 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 14 Musical Emotions → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 13	
WEEK 3 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 15 Dynamics → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 14	
WEEK 4 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 16 Legato and Staccato → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 15	
WEEK 5 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 17 Dynamics, Rhythms, and Emotional Effects → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 16	
WEEK 6 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 18 Crescendos and Decrescendos → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups	

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Term 2	
	→ LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 17
WEEK 7	10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 19 <i>Comb. Rhythms, Melodies, Dynamics</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 18
WEEK 8	10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 20 <i>Vocal Exercises</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 19
WEEK 9	10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 21 <i>Intervals</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 20
WEEK 10	10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 22 <i>Rhythmic and Melodic Patterns (cont.)</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 21
WEEK 11	10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 23 <i>Rhythmic and Melodic Patterns (cont.)</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 22

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Term 2

WEEK 12 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 24

Exam Week

→ EXAMS

Answer question(s) related to course.

Questions will come from: Sol-fa Level 1 Coursework





Term 3

WEEK 1  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 25 <i>Introduction to Sol-fa Signs</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 23 → VIEW ∞ Image Link: Curwen Hand Signs	
WEEK 2  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 26 <i>Do, Re, Mi</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 24	
WEEK 3  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 27 <i>Singing Do, Re, & Mi</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 25	
WEEK 4  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 28 <i>Musical Patterns with Do, Re, & Mi</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 26	
WEEK 5  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 29 <i>Pentatonic Scale</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 27	



Term 3

WEEK 6  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 30 <i>Hand Signs for Fa & So</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 28	
WEEK 7  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 31 <i>Intervals with Pentatonic Scale</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 29	
WEEK 8  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 32 <i>Quarter Notes</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → VIEW & PRACTICE ∞ Video Link: How to Draw a Quarter Note → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 30	
WEEK 9  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 33 <i>Sol-fa with Quarter Notes</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 31	
WEEK 10  10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 34 <i>Intervals (cont.)</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 32	

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Term 3

WEEK 11 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 35 <i>Recap</i> → RECAP Warm up your voice and review concepts from the previous lesson. ∞ Audio Link: Warm-Ups → LISTEN & PRACTICE Repeat the notes, melodies, or rhythms as directed. ∞ Audio Link: Lesson 33	
WEEK 12 10m Sol-fa: Level 1 - Lesson 36 <i>Exam Week</i> → EXAMS Answer question(s) related to course. Questions will come from: Sol-fa Level 1 Coursework	

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Examination

- Term 1**
- The teacher should clap and have the student imitate the following rhythms: (The quick claps should be about twice as fast as the slow claps.)
 - 1) slow, slow, quick, quick, slow
 - 2) quick, quick, slow, slow, quick, quick
- Term 2**
- Sing a few notes that are piano, then sing a few notes forte. OR Sing a few notes that are legato and a few notes that are staccato. (Note to teacher: Piano means “soft,” forte means “loud,” legato means “fluid/smooth/connected,” and staccato means “sharp/separated.”)
- Term 3**
- Sing the following Sol-fa patterns with your hand signs:
 - 1) do-re-mi-fa-so
 - 2) do-mi-so-mi-do